

Role of Leadership

Sir Syed Ahmad Khan

SIR SYED AHMAD KHAN

AS A SOCIAL REFORMER, A POLITICAL LEADER, A RELIGIOUS THINKER, AS A MORALIST, A RATIONALIST, A HUMANIST AND A JURIST, HE CONTRIBUTED MUCH TO THE REALM OF THEOLOGY , PHILOSOPHY, RELIGION, HISTORY, LITERATURE, EDUCATION AND POLITICS, BESIDES BUILDING EDUCATION INSTITUTES WHICH AIMED AT ERADICATING IGNORANCE, APATHY AND SUPERSTITION.

• INTRODUCTION

- Sir Syed Ahmad Khan was the political and intellectual influence for the rehabilitation of the Muslims who recovered them from the socio-political, economic and intellectual darkness after the War of Independence.

Although the British historian like Sir Richard Temple, John Strachey and W.H. Gregory at the later period had realized that the Muslims were not lone responsible for the “Mutiny”, it was Sir Syed who in fact convinced the British earlier about this truth. (Racial misunderstanding and administrative blunder).

- Sir Syed was born in Delhi in 1817 in highly respectable family. He entered the service of East India Company and rose to the position of judge in 1846.
- During 1857 he served with loyalty and distinction.
- He was appointed Chief justice in Muradabad and was later transferred to Ghazi pore. In 1864 he was transferred to Aligarh where he played an important part in establishing the college.
- In 1876 he retired from his work to concentrate on running the college and devoting himself to improve the position of Muslims through education. He died on 27 March 1898.

IQBAL'S VIEW ON CONTRIBUTION OF SIR SYED AHMED KHAN IN MUSLIM RENAISSANCE

- The real greatness of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan consist in the fact that he was the first Indian Muslim who felt the need of fresh orientation of Islam and worked for it- his sensitive nature was the first to react against modern age.
- Education was the foundation on which he built the super structure of his religious, social, economic and political ideas.

PHILOSOPHY/STRATEGY OF SIR SYED AHMED KHAN

TRINITY OF IDEAS

1. Loyalty (loyal to government)
2. Devotion (acquisition of scientific and religious knowledge)
3. Aloofness (avoid political activities)

Educational Services of Aligarh Movement

- Sir Syed Ahmed Khan wanted the Muslim nation to be educated to keep pace with the modern advancement. He was of the opinion that honour of the nation could be achieved only by education. He advised the Muslims to get the most modern western education. He established educational institutions for the Muslim youth and guided them both theoretically and practically.
- Sir Syed Ahmed Khan established the educational institution in Muradabad 1859. That was a Persian school.
School in Ghazi Pur Sir Syed Ahmed Khan established a school in Ghazi Pur in 1862.

SCIENTIFIC SOCIETY

- Sir Syed established a unique institution Scientific Society in Ghazipur in 1863. The purpose of its establishment was to acquire the books in other languages, and translate them in Urdu. Sir Syed stressed upon the need for education in English language so that the Muslim generation could learn the Western and modern knowledge as soon as possible.
- Sir Syed Ahmed Khan set up M.A.O. School in Aligarh in 1875; later on (in 1877) it was upgraded to college. This institution became Muslim University Aligarh in 1920.
- Sir Syed established another organization in 1886 to provide funds to fulfill the requirements of Aligarh movement. This organization served the Muslim community in all the fields (social, political and religious). The main aim was to inspire the Muslims to work in the field of education.

LITERARY SERVICES

- **Khutabat-e-Ahmadia**
- **Tabbain-ul-Kalam**
- **Risala Tehzib-ul-Ikhlaq**
- **Asar-us-Sanadeed**
- **Risala-e-Asbabe-Baghawat-e-Hind**
- **Loyal Muhammadans of India**
- **Muhammadan Educational Conference**
- **Indian Patriotic Association**
- **Muhammadan Anglo Oriental Defense Association**
- **Vernacular University**

SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC SERVICES

- Sir Syed took many steps to regain the lost social and economic status of the Muslims. The suppressed and ruined community became dynamic.
- Sir Syed Ahmed guided the Muslims on every level to regain their lost glory. The instrument that he used for social reformation was educational institutions.

Government Jobs for the Muslims

As a result of Sir Syed's campaign, the Muslims of India got remarkable jobs in Govt. sector on a large scale.

Orphanages

- He established orphanages for Muslim children so that they may not become Hindu or Christian. It was really a great service of him. In this way he tried to construct a bridge between the British and the Muslims. He succeeded in getting attitude finally changed and the Muslims, once again, joined the main stream.

- **Economic Progress**

Aligarh Movement attracted the Muslims towards education and made them enabled to improve their economic conditions. By getting the share in government jobs, the Muslims rose to the higher positions, and in this way the economic condition of the Muslims improved a lot.

Political Services

Sir Syed advised the Muslims to remain away from politics and he himself took important steps to educate the Muslims for their socio-economic restoration so that they might acquire the status equivalent to that of Hindus. He was of the view that education is the only weapon to keep pace with model advancement.

Two Nation Theory

He was no doubt in the favour of Hindu Muslim unity in the beginning but after Urdu-Hindi Controversy he came to know the nature of the Hindu nation. Then for the first time in the History he used the word “Nation” for the Muslim in 1867. He said, “***After the linguistic wrangle, now I am convinced that the two communities will not join whole heartedly in anything.....he who lives will see.***”

So we can say he was the founder of two-nation theory in sub-continent. On the basis of Two Nation Theory, Sir Syed asked for special safeguards for the Muslims in different fields. Special seats for the Muslims in the local councils.

- **Quota in services**

Started a movement against the open competitive examinations for superior services. Rejected the government of the majorities because that could lead to the monopoly of the Hindus.

- **Advice to avoid politics**

After the war of 1857, he advised the Muslims to remain away from politics until they would become strong in education.

- **Urdu Hindi Controversy**

After Urdu Hindi Controversy in Binaras Sir Syed understood the mentality of the Hindus and he pressurized the British to avoid replacing Urdu with Hindi.

- **Behaviour towards Indian National Congress**

Sir Syed forbade the Muslims to join the Indian National Congress founded by A.O. Hume in 1885, as he could understand the objectives of this party.

Political Reforms

He restrained the Muslims from joining congress and struggle for special seat of the Muslims in legislative council. He also started a movement against the open competitive exams to avoid the monopoly of the Hindus.

Illbert Bill

Legislative Bill extending jurisdiction of Indian judges to conduct trial of European criminals.

CAUSES OF INDIAN REVOLT

Sir Syed attributed the following reasons to the outbreak of the war of Independence:

- Non-representation of the Indians in the legislative councils.
- Forcible conversion of Indians to Christianity. And unrestrained zeal of Christian missionaries.
- Mismanagement of Indian army.
- Many other ill-advised measures of the Government which created large scale dissatisfaction among the various sections of society.
- Financial policies of East India Company
- Fiscal monopoly of British crushed the local business.

ANALYSIS OF ALIGARH MOVEMENT

- **English-Muslim Reconciliation**

Due to Aligarh Movement the feelings of hatred against Muslims started diminishing from the hearts of the English. The English started coming closer to the Muslims.

- **Protection of rights**

Aligarh Movement created an awareness of the protection of rights among the Muslims. Sir Syed spent whole of his life in improving the educational, social, economic and political affairs of the Muslims.

- **Supply of Political Leadership**

The Muslims got education from Aligarh Movement and made themselves capable to face Hindus and the English. Muslim League was established by the educated political leadership that also owed to Aligarh Movement. Political awareness was created among the masses by Aligarh Movement.

- **Concept of Separate Nation/Foundation stone of Pakistan**

Aligarh Movement made the Muslims realized that they were a separate nation having a glorious past, and also made it clear that Hindus and Muslims were two nations and could not unite together. Moreover Hindus were not the well-wishers of Muslims. This two nation theory was made the basis of Pakistan Movement by Allama Iqbal and Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah who got a separate homeland for Muslims and it served as a foundation stone of Pakistan.

- **Muslim Unity**

Aligarh Movement created a sense of Muslims nationality. A Muslim wherever he lives in the world is a member of Muslim 'Nation'. In 1919 the educated youth of Aligarh College launched Khilafat Movement for the Muslims of Turkey. They created a sense of unity among the Muslims. Hence feelings of union, relationship and brotherhood were developed among them.

- **Acquisition of Western Education**

Muslims were afraid of western education but they could not make progress without it. As the source of modern sciences was the English language so it was necessary for them to learn it. Therefore arrangements of western sciences side by side with Islamic education were made in Aligarh College that motivated a large number of Muslims to get education.

- **Richard Symonds** in **“The Making of Pakistan”**, writes about Sir Syed Ahmed Khan

“No single individual had a greater responsibility for the recovery of political influence after the mutiny and for the adjustment of Indian Muslims to Western ideas than Sir Syed Ahmed Khan”

- **Ishtiaq Hussain Qureshi** in **“The struggle for Pakistan”**, writes about him

“His contribution to Muslim Renaissance in India can be summarized in one phrase i.e. that it was inculcation of self confidence in his people.”

GUIDELINES FOR LECTURES

- Students you may find slight variation in the outline as I may modify it according to the current circumstances. 6th week lecture comprises of the Role of leadership that include Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, Allama Iqbal and Quaid.
- This ppt explains the role of Sir Syed and for rest two consult your syllabus book. I am sending you the pics of the relevant pages.
- Go through this material and make your own notes.
- In case of any query or question you can email me or whats app on my personal no.
- Stay home stay safe, together we can succeed.
- Good luck.